

Psalms 145

I Will Extol Thee, My God, O King

The Lord is gracious, and full of compassion; slow to anger, and of great mercy

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *I will extol thee, my God, O king; and I will bless thy name for ever and ever.*
- 2 *Every day will I bless thee; and I will praise thy name for ever and ever.*
- 3 *Great is the LORD, and greatly to be praised; and his greatness is unsearchable.*
- 4 *One generation shall praise thy works to another, and shall declare thy mighty acts.*
- 5 *I will speak of the glorious honour of thy majesty, and of thy wondrous works.*
- 6 *And men shall speak of the might of thy terrible acts: and I will declare thy greatness.*
- 7 *They shall abundantly utter the memory of thy great goodness, and shall sing of thy righteousness.*
- 8 *The LORD is gracious, and full of compassion; slow to anger, and of great mercy.*
- 9 *The LORD is good to all: and his tender mercies are over all his works.*
- 10 *All thy works shall praise thee, O LORD; and thy saints shall bless thee.*
- 11 *They shall speak of the glory of thy kingdom, and talk of thy power;*
- 12 *To make known to the sons of men his mighty acts, and the glorious majesty of his kingdom.*
- 13 *Thy kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and thy dominion endureth throughout all generations.*
- 14 *The LORD upholdeth all that fall, and raiseth up all those that be bowed down.*
- 15 *The eyes of all wait upon thee; and thou givest them their meat in due season.*
- 16 *Thou openest thine hand, and satisfiest the desire of every living thing.*
- 17 *The LORD is righteous in all his ways, and holy in all his works.*
- 18 *The LORD is nigh unto all them that call upon him, to all that call upon him in truth.*
- 19 *He will fulfil the desire of them that fear him: he also will hear their cry, and will save them.*
- 20 *The LORD preserveth all them that love him: but all the wicked will he destroy.*
- 21 *My mouth shall speak the praise of the LORD: and let all flesh bless his holy name for ever and ever.*

2 · CONTEXT

An acrostic psalm of pure praise, moving through God's greatness, His compassionate character, the everlasting scope of His kingdom, and His attentive care for all creation, before closing with universal invitation to bless His name. Henry treats verse 8's description of God's character—gracious, compassionate, slow to anger, abundant in mercy—as the psalm's theological hinge, the quality that makes every other declaration of greatness good news rather than merely impressive.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

David commits to extol God daily and bless His name forever, declaring His greatness unsearchable—too vast to be fully measured even across a lifetime of praise.

Verse 4-7

Praise is pictured as passing from generation to generation, each declaring God's mighty acts, His glorious majesty, His wondrous works, and the fame of His great goodness—corporate memory sustaining what any single generation could not fully express alone.

Verse 8-9

The psalm's central description of character follows: gracious, full of compassion, slow to anger, abundant in mercy, good to all, with tender mercies extending over everything He has made—the foundation beneath every other claim of greatness in the psalm.

Verse 10-13

All God's works are said to praise Him, and His saints specifically bless Him, speaking of the glory of His kingdom and making His mighty acts known to all people. His kingdom is declared everlasting, His dominion enduring through every generation.

Verse 14-16

Attentive care is detailed concretely: God upholds all who fall, raises up those bowed down, and the eyes of all creatures wait upon Him as He gives them food in due season, satisfying the desire of every living thing—provision described as personal and immediate, not distant.

Verse 17-19

God's righteousness and holiness are affirmed across all His ways and works, alongside His nearness to everyone who calls on Him in truth, His readiness to fulfill the desires of those who fear Him, and His attentiveness to their cry, saving them.

Verse 20-21

The psalm closes with a clear distinction: God preserves all who love Him but destroys the wicked, and ends in a personal vow paired with universal invitation—David's own mouth will speak God's praise, while all flesh is called to bless His holy name forever.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

God's greatness, described throughout this psalm in cosmic and universal terms, is grounded specifically in His gracious, compassionate, slow-to-anger character—without that foundation, greatness alone would be merely impressive rather than good news. Attentive, personal care for the fallen, the hungry, and the crying out flows directly from that same character, showing that transcendent majesty and intimate provision are two expressions of a single nature.

Application for life today.

Let verse 8's description of God's character become a daily meditation, especially when circumstances make His goodness feel uncertain or distant. Notice how concretely the psalm describes provision—upholding the falling, feeding the hungry, hearing the cry—and let that specificity shape how you notice God's care in your own ordinary days. Consider what it means to pass praise to the next generation, as verse 4 pictures, rather than keeping your own experience of God's goodness to yourself.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. How does verse 8's description of God as gracious, compassionate, and slow to anger reshape your view of Him in a season where His goodness feels uncertain?

2. Where in your own life can you concretely see the kind of attentive care described in verses 14–16—being upheld, fed, or answered in your cry?

3. What would it look like for you to actively pass on your experience of God's goodness to the next generation, as verse 4 describes, rather than keeping it private?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).